

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP): Weekly UK Banking Adverse News Screening & Executive Briefing Workflow

Scope: UK Regulated Financial Institutions & Banking Sector

AI Platform: Gemini (Deep Research Enabled)

1. Objective & Purpose

To establish a repeatable, standardized SOP for screening, analyzing, and reporting weekly adverse news affecting UK-regulated financial institutions. Using a hybrid workflow combining media monitoring ingestion (e.g., Silobreaker) and structured **Gemini Deep Research Prompts**, this workflow ensures senior executives receive direct, concise, high-impact intelligence free from noise, positive updates, or routine commercial news.

2. Screening Scope & Timelines

- **Frequency:** Weekly (executed every Monday morning covering the previous 7-day cycle).
- **Screening Window:** Rolling 7-day period (e.g., 21–28 July 2026).
- **Target Universe:** Master monitoring list of 130+ UK-regulated banks, building societies, and foreign subsidiaries operating in the UK (ingested via HTML/CSV export from Silobreaker or central CRM).

3. The 5-Pillar Adverse News Risk Framework

All identified news items must be filtered against the 5 qualifying risk pillars below. Items failing to meet at least one pillar—or representing neutral/positive updates—must be strictly excluded.

Risk Pillar	Qualifying Criteria	Exclusion Criteria (Discard)
1. Regulatory & Legal Enforcement	Regulatory fines, settlements, formal investigations (FCA, PRA, SEC, CFTC, NYDFS); license suspensions; class actions, IP litigation.	Routine supervisory meetings, standard policy responses, completed non-material filings.
2. Financial Crime & Integrity	AML/KYC control failures; sanctions evasions (OFAC,	General industry fraud warnings without entity

	UK Sanctions); fraud schemes, market manipulation, misleading disclosures.	tie-in, generic cybersecurity tips.
3. Executive & Key Person Risk	Formal executive scrutiny; legal trouble, corruption, toxicity; material board governance disputes; unapproved conflicts of interest.	Standard executive appointments, routine retirement announcements, conference speeches.
4. Operational & Security Risks	Core banking or payment rail outages (Faster Payments, CHAPS, Bacs); cyber attacks, data breaches; customer ledger desynchronization.	Scheduled system maintenance, brief planned downtime with zero customer impact.
5. Financial Health & Stability	Liquidity crunches, emergency central bank liquidity; capital add-ons; rating downgrades; mass distress layoffs (>15–20%); insolvency.	Routine quarterly earnings reports, standard bond issuances, business as usual restructures.

4. End-to-End Operational Workflow

[Step 1: Media Ingestion] → [Step 2: Gemini Screening Prompt] → [Step 3: Synthesis & Verification] → [Step 4: Formatting Prompt] → [Step 5: Email Dispatch]

Step 1: Data Ingestion & Target List Preparation

1. Export the 7-day heat/volume tracking file (HTML or CSV) from the primary media monitoring tool (e.g., Silobreaker).
2. Note entities exhibiting elevated heat or volume spikes for priority cross-checking.
3. Attach the HTML entity list directly to the Gemini workspace or load the list into context.

Step 2: Gemini Deep Research & Screening Execution

Input the **Master Research & Screening Prompt** into Gemini (see Section 5 for exact template). Gemini will:

- Scan the attached target universe.
- Cross-reference web intelligence for the designated 7-day date window.
- Filter out non-adverse news.
- Map qualifying events strictly to the 5 risk pillars.

Step 3: Content Verification & Categorization

Review Gemini's initial output against source references to ensure:

- **Systemic Operational Failures** (multi-bank outages/rail disruptions) are isolated into Section 1.
- **Institution-Specific Developments** (misconduct, lawsuits, fines) are grouped by bank in Section 2.
- **Regulatory Policy & Enforcement Trajectory** (systemic regulator moves) are placed in Section 3.

Step 4: Executive Style & Formatting Application

Run the **Executive Styling Refinement Prompt** (Section 5) in Gemini to convert the raw facts into executive-ready markdown.

- **Formatting Rules:**
 - Structure: Plain-text bullet points with zero conversational filler.
 - Typography: Strategic **Bold** for primary metrics, entities, dates, and amounts (e.g., **Barclays PLC, £600M, 27–28 July**); *Italics* for court venues, legal principles, and consultation papers (e.g., *US Federal Court, Principle 12, CP26/19*).
 - Direct & Impersonal tone.

Step 5: Delivery & Email Protocol

Insert the finalized output into the direct email template for executive dispatch (no attachments).

5. Master Gemini Prompt Templates

Prompt Template 1: Weekly Screening & Deep Research

Role: Senior Risk & Financial Crime Analyst.

Task: Conduct an adverse news screening for UK-regulated financial institutions for the period [Start Date] to [End Date].

Inputs:

- Attached list of UK financial entities: [Attach File / Insert HTML Data]
- Date Range: [Start Date] to [End Date]

Instructions:

1. Screen all entities on the provided list against news published within the date range.

2. Apply the 5-Pillar Adverse News Framework:
 - Pillar 1: Regulatory & Legal Enforcement
 - Pillar 2: Financial Crime & Integrity
 - Pillar 3: Executive & Key Person Risk
 - Pillar 4: Operational & Security Risks
 - Pillar 5: Financial Health & Stability
3. Strictly DISCARD all neutral news, earnings reports, product launches, sponsorships, and macro commentary.
4. Verify entity relevance (must be UK-regulated or material overseas parent action affecting UK operations).
5. Output verified facts categorized into:
 - Systemic Operational Failures
 - Institution-Specific Adverse Developments
 - Regulatory Policy & Enforcement Trajectory

Prompt Template 2: Executive Styling & Formatting Refinement

Task: Refine the approved adverse news findings into an Executive Briefing format.

Formatting & Styling Requirements:

1. Tone: Direct, concise, objective, and completely impersonal. No conversational intro/outro.
2. Structure:
 - EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (2 bullet points on top sector risks & regulator posture)
 - SECTION 1: CRITICAL OPERATIONAL FAILURES
 - SECTION 2: INSTITUTION-SPECIFIC ADVERSE DEVELOPMENTS (Grouped by Bank Name)
 - SECTION 3: REGULATORY POLICY & ENFORCEMENT TRAJECTORY
3. Typography Enhancements:
 - BOLD (**text**): Key entity names, financial penalties/amounts (£/\$), key metrics, dates, and primary risk drivers.
 - ITALIC (*text*): Court venues, official consultation papers, legal doctrines, and specific regulatory principles.
4. Output in clean Markdown format ready for email embedding.

6. Email Delivery Protocol

When sending the finalized briefing via direct email body:

- **Subject Line Convention:** Executive Briefing: UK Banking Sector Adverse News ([Start Date]–[End Date] [Year])
- **Greeting:** Short and direct (e.g., Hi [First Name],).
- **Introductory Line:** Single line stating coverage scope and dates.
- **Body:** Full Markdown text embedded directly in the email (no attachments).

- **Sign-off:** Best regards,